G7-8 English Assessment Answer Key

Skill codes: KD Key Details & Evidence · CP Main Idea & Purpose · WC Word Meaning & Author's Craft · SS Sentence Structure · VA Verbs & Agreement · PM Pronouns & Modifiers · PC Punctuation · TR Transitions

#	Ans	Skill	Why it is correct / common trap
1	**A**	CP	Paragraph 1 explains why solar energy is useful; paragraph 2 adds its benefit and its challenge. The other choices are details or not in the text.
2	**C**	KD	Sentence 2: it is renewable "because the sun will keep producing energy for billions of years." B and D contradict the passage.
3	**D**	WC	The benefit is that solar energy "does not hurt the environment," which is a good thing. "However... one challenge" signals the contrast.
4	**B**	CP	The passage follows his life from poor beginnings to the richest man in the world. A is too negative; C and D are details.
5	**D**	KD	"Humble" means poor or modest. Learning "what poverty meant" is the direct evidence. C is the cause, not the humble beginning itself.
6	**C**	WC	He would "cure" poverty, which means solve it. A and B are the medical meanings; choosing them means the student ignored context.
7	**A**	KD	Paragraph 6: he "vowed to retire from business two years later."
8	**B**	CP	The paragraph builds to "Carnegie ingeniously built the Carnegie Steel empire." A, C, and D are supporting details.
9	**B**	WC	The quote comes right before the list of his donations and explains why he gave his money away.
10	**C**	SS	Two independent clauses joined by ", and" make a compound sentence. B is complex; A and D are simple.
11	**A**	SS	A has a subject but no main verb ("which barks" is a clause). C is complete: the subject "you" is understood.
12	**C**	VA	In "there is/are" sentences, the subject comes after the verb: "reasons" is plural, so use "are."
13	**A**	VA	The subject is "teacher" (singular). "Along with her students" doesn't change it, so it should be "is going."
14	**A**	VA	After verbs like insist, demand, or recommend + that, use the base form (subjunctive). This is a challenge item; many students choose C.
15	**D**	PM	After the preposition "to," use the object pronoun. Test it: "given to me," not "given to I."
16	**B**	PM	Don't switch from "a student" to "you." Keep the pronoun consistent.
17	**C**	PM	"Did" is an action verb, so it needs the adverb "well." "Good" is an adjective.
18	**D**	PM	Use the comparative (more) for two items and the superlative (most) for three or more. Never use "more" + -er.
19	**D**	SS	The person who finished the marathon (Diego) must come right after the comma. C is a trap: the subject is "wish," not Diego.
20	**B**	SS	Parallel structure: read, answer, and write (all base verbs).
21	**D**	SS	"Not only... but also" needs a complete, parallel verb: "it also flooded."
22	**B**	PC	Use a comma before a tag question.
23	**B**	PC	Use a comma before a FANBOYS conjunction that joins two independent clauses.

#	Ans	Skill	Why it is correct / common trap
24	**C**	PC	With only one best friend, "Jada" and "who lives next door" are extra information, so each gets a pair of commas.
25	**D**	PC	Plural possessive ending in s: players'.
26	**C**	PC	Who's = who is. Whose shows possession.
27	**A**	PC	A simple plural takes no apostrophe: lamps.
28	**B**	PC	When an interrupted quotation continues the same sentence, the second part starts with a lowercase letter.
29	**D**	PC	Short story titles go in double quotation marks, with no extra commas or periods.
30	**C**	TR	Swimming in July is one example of loving summer.
31	**A**	TR	Practicing caused the improvement, so this is cause and effect.

Writing Rubric (20 points)

Option A · Personal Experience

Criterion	Strong	Partial	Weak / Missing
Focus 4 pts	4: One clear event; the story has a clear point	2–3: Event is clear but the point is vague, or it covers too many events	0–1: No clear event; jumps between topics
Development 6 pts	5–6: Specific actions, feelings, sensory details, or dialogue that show the experience	3–4: Some details, but mostly tells ("it was hard") instead of shows	0–2: A list of events with almost no detail
Reflection 4 pts	4: Explains clearly what was learned or how the writer changed	2–3: States a lesson in one general line ("I learned to never give up")	0–1: No reflection
Organization 3 pts	3: Clear beginning, middle, end; time transitions	2: Mostly in order; some jumps	0–1: Hard to follow
Language & Conventions 3 pts	3: Varied sentences, consistent past tense, few errors	2: Some errors or tense shifts; meaning clear	0–1: Frequent errors interfere with meaning

Option B · Argument

Criterion	Strong	Partial	Weak / Missing
Claim 4 pts	4: Clear opinion that directly answers the question	2–3: Opinion is stated but general, or wavers	0–1: No clear opinion
Reasons & Evidence 6 pts	5–6: Two or more reasons, each with a specific example that is explained	3–4: Reasons are relevant, but examples are general or not explained	0–2: Opinions only, with no examples
Other side 4 pts	4: States the other side fairly and explains why it is weaker	2–3: Mentions the other side with little or no response	0–1: Other side not mentioned
Organization 3 pts	3: Introduction, body paragraphs, conclusion; clear transitions	2: Mostly organized; basic transitions	0–1: No paragraphs; hard to follow
Language & Conventions 3 pts	3: Varied sentences, few errors	2: Some errors; meaning clear	0–1: Frequent errors interfere with meaning

Reading the writing score

Score	What it usually means
17–20	Strong for Grade 7–8. Ready for high school literary analysis and longer arguments.
13–16	Solid. Usually loses points on general examples or a one-line lesson or rebuttal.
9–12	Has ideas but lacks structure or detail. Teach paragraph models (CER for argument; show-don't-tell for narrative).
0–8	Needs sentence- and paragraph-level support first, using frames and modeled paragraphs before full essays.

Overall Level & Recommended Tutoring

Total	Level	What it means	Recommended tutoring
90–100	Advanced	Above grade level. Reads longer nonfiction well, has solid grammar, and writes organized essays.	1 session/week. High school prep: literary analysis, ISEE/SSAT upper level, essay style.
75–89	Proficient	On grade level with 1–2 weak skills, often main idea or punctuation, or thin writing detail.	1–2 sessions/week. Target weak skills; paragraph writing with evidence; vocabulary routine.
60–74	Developing	Understands short texts but struggles with longer passages, purpose questions, and grammar rules.	2 sessions/week. Active reading routine; grammar by error type; structured paragraphs.
Below 60	Foundational	Below grade level. Likely gaps in vocabulary, sentence boundaries, and reading stamina.	2–3 sessions/week. Core vocabulary, sentence-level grammar, short leveled texts, sentence frames. Consider an ELD-level check.

Skill → tutoring focus

Skill	If weak, the student usually…	Tutoring focus
Key Details & Evidence	Answers from memory instead of going back to the text	“Prove it” habit: underline the sentence that supports each answer
Main Idea & Purpose	Picks a true detail instead of the big idea	Summarize each paragraph in one sentence; “Does this cover the whole paragraph?”
Word Meaning & Author's Craft	Uses the first meaning they know; misses why a quote is included	Context clues; prefixes and roots; “Why did the author put this here?”
Sentence Structure	Writes fragments and run-ons; misplaced modifiers	Subject + verb + complete thought; combining sentences; parallel lists
Verbs & Agreement	Matches the verb to the nearest noun	Find the real subject (cross out “along with…” phrases); there is/are
Pronouns & Modifiers	Uses “me/I” and “good/well” by sound	Pronoun test (remove the other person); adjective vs. adverb; comparatives
Punctuation	Guesses on commas and apostrophes	Comma rules (FANBOYS, extra information, tag questions); apostrophes; dialogue and titles
Transitions	Chooses by sound, not logic	Name the relationship first (cause, contrast, example), then choose the word
Writing	Lists events or opinions without detail	Show-don't-tell; CER paragraphs; reflection and counterargument sentence frames